

servantiae, plena etiam antiquitatis. Isto in genere et fuimus ipsi, cum ambitionis nostrae tempora postulabant, et clarissimos viros esse vidimus et hodie esse videmus quam plurimos gratiosos. Decuriatio tribulium, descriptio populi, suffragia largitione devincta severitatem senatus et bonorum omnium vim ac dolorem excitarunt. Haec doce, haec profer, huc incumbe, Laterensis, decuriasse Plancium, conscripsisse, sequestrem fuisse, pronuntiasse, divisisse: tum mirabor te iis armis uti, quae tibi lex dabat, noluisse. Tribulibus enim iudicibus non modo severitatem illorum, si ista vera sunt, sed ne vultus quidem ferre possemus.

46 Hanc tu rationem cum fugeris, cumque eos iudices habere nolueris, quorum in huius delicto cum scientia certissima, tum dolor gravissimus esse debuerit, quid apud hos dices, qui abs te taciti requirunt cur hoc sibi oneris imposueris, cur se potissimum delegeris, cur denique se divinare malueris quam eos, qui scirent, iudicare?

of courtesy, kindness, and chivalry. Such a course I have myself adopted, when it has been required by the exigencies of my own candidature; I have seen many eminent men do the like, and to-day we see very many men who enjoy popularity. It is the systematic organization of the tribes and the electorate into sections and allotments, and the restriction of the freedom of the poll by bribery, which in the past has awakened the severity of the senate and the indignant wrath of all good patriots. Bend all your powers, Laterensis, to the task of demonstrating by substantial proof that Plancius resorted to sectional canvassing, to making a register of votes of which he was secure, to being a depository of bribes, or that he made any promises or distributions of money whatsoever; and if you can prove this, I shall be surprised that you refused to avail yourself of those weapons which the law put into your hands. For were his jury to-day his tribesmen, we should find not merely their severity but even their gaze intolerable, supposing that your allegations were
46 true. But now that you have declined such a course of action, and have refused to empanel men who, in dealing with any delinquencies of my client, would have shown a most indubitable acquaintance with the facts and a most overwhelming indignation, what can you say to the present jury, who in silent perplexity are wondering why you should have laid this burden upon them, why you should have gone out of your way to choose them to sit upon the bench, and why you should prefer their guess-work to the verdict of those who could base their judgment upon knowledge?